

Haab'

The **Haab'** (Mayan pronunciation: [haːb]) is part of the Maya calendric system. It was a 365-day calendar used by many of the pre-Columbian cultures of Mesoamerica.

Description

The Haab' comprises eighteen months of twenty days each, plus an additional period of five days ("nameless days") at the end of the year known as *Wayeb'* (or *Uayeb* in 16th-century orthography).

Bricker (1982) estimates that the Haab' was first used around 500 BCE with a starting point of the winter solstice.^[2]

The Haab' month names are most commonly referred to by their names in colonial-era Yucatec (Yukatek). In sequence, these (in the revised orthography^[3]) are as seen on the right: Each day in the Haab' calendar was identified by a day number within the month followed by the name of the month. Day numbers began with a glyph translated as the "seating of" a named month, which is usually regarded as day 0 of that month, although a minority treat it as day 20 of the month preceding the named month. In the latter case, the seating of Pop is day 5 of Wayeb'. For the majority, the first day of the year was Seating Pop. This was followed by 1 Pop, 2 Pop ... 19 Pop, Seating Wo, 1 Wo and so on.

Inscriptions on The Temple of the Cross at Palenque shows clearly that the Maya were aware of the true length of the year, even though they did not employ the use of leap days in their system of calculations generally. J. Eric Thompson^[4] wrote that the Maya knew of the drift between the Haab' and the solar year and that they made "calculations as to the rate at which the error accumulated, but these were merely noted as corrections they were not used to change the calendar."

Today (at <u>UTC+00</u>) Friday, 11 September 2026	
<u>Maya</u>	<u>13.0.13.16.12</u> <u>5 Chen, 11 Eb</u>
Other calendars	
<u>Akan</u>	Kurufie
<u>Armenian</u>	23 Hori 1476
<u>Aztec</u>	Tititl 4, 11 Malinalli
<u>Babylonian</u>	28 Abu, 2337 <u>SE</u>
<u>Balinese pawukon</u>	Luang, Pepet, Pasah, Laba, Umanis, Paniron, Sukra of Menail, Brahma, Nohan, Pati
<u>Bengali</u>	27 Bhadro, <u>BS</u> 1433
<u>Chinese</u>	<u>Yang Earth Rat</u> • <u>Ghost Mansion</u> 1 Bāyuè, Bǐngwǔnián (Bailu, 12 days until <u>Qiu</u> fen)
<u>Common Era</u>	<u>11 September 2026</u> <u>CE</u>
<u>Coptic</u>	1 Thout, <u>AM</u> 1743
<u>Egyptian</u>	28 Tybi, 2775 <u>NE</u>
<u>Ethiopian</u>	1 Maskaram, 2019 Amätä Məhrät
<u>French Republican</u>	Décade III, Quintidi de Fructidor de l'Année 234 de la République
<u>Gregorian</u>	<u>11 September, AD 2026</u>
<u>Hebrew</u>	29 Elul, <u>AM</u> 5786
<u>Hindu</u>	<u>Pūrvaphalgunī</u> • <u>Sādhya</u> Solar: 26 <u>Bhādrapada</u> , 1948 <u>SE</u> Lunisolar: <u>Amāvasyā</u> , <u>Kṛishna pakṣa</u> of <u>Śrāvaṇa</u> , 2083 <u>VE</u> <u>Rāudra</u> • 5127 <u>KY</u> • <u>1,872,829</u>

Five unlucky days

The five nameless days at the end of the calendar, called Wayeb', was thought to be a dangerous time. Foster (2002) writes "During Wayeb, portals between the mortal realm and the Underworld dissolved. No boundaries prevented the ill-intending deities from causing disasters." To ward off these evil spirits, the Mayans had customs and rituals they practised during Wayeb'. For example, the Mayans would not leave their homes and wash their hair.

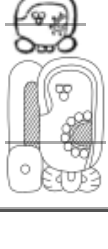
Notes

- 1. Kettunen and Helmke (2005), pp.47–48
- 2. Zero Pop actually fell on the same day as the solstice on –575 December 27, –574 December 27, –573 December 27, and –572 December 26 (astronomical year numbering, Universal Time), if one does not account for the fact that the Maya region is in roughly time zone UT–6. See "IMCCE seasons" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20120823124027/http://www.imcce.fr/en/grandpublic/temps/saisons.php>).

Icelandic	Föstudagur, 18 Tvímánuður 2026
Islamic	28 Rabi' al-awwal, AH 1448 (using tabular method)
ISO week date	2026-W37-5
Japanese	1 Hazuki, Reiwa 8 (Hakuro, 12 days until Shūbun)
Julian	29 August, AD 2026 (AM 7534)
Julian day	2461295
Maya	13.0.13.16.12 5 Chen, 11 Eb
Roman	ante diem IV Kalendas Septembres, MMDCCCLXXIX AUC
Solar Hijri	20 Shahrivar, SH 1405
Tibetan	30 gro bzhin, me pho rta 2153 or 1772 or 1000

Haab' months: names in glyphs^[1] in sequence

Nº. Seq.	Name of month	Glyph examples	glyph meaning	Nº. Seq.	Name of month	Glyph examples	glyph meaning
1	Pop		mat	10	Yax		green storm
2	Wo'		black conjunction	11	Sak'		white storm
3	Sip		red conjunction	12	Keh		red storm

4	Sotz'		bat	13	Mak		enclosed
5	Sek		death	14	K'ank'in		yellow sun
6	Xul		dog	15	Muwan		owl
7	Yaxk'in		new sun	16	Pax		planting time
8	Mol		water	17	K'ayab'		turtle
9	Ch'en		black storm	18	Kumk'u		granary
				19	Wayeb'		five unlucky days

Archived from the original (<http://www.imcce.fr/en/grandpublic/temps/saisons.php>) on 2012-08-23.

3. Again, per Kettunen and Helmke (2005)

4. J. Eric Thompson (1971). *Maya Hieroglyphic Writing*. University of Oklahoma Press. p. 121. ISBN 0-8061-0958-0.

References

- Bricker, Victoria (1982). "The Origin of the Maya Solar Calendar". *Current Anthropology*. **23** (1): 101–103. doi:[10.1086/202782](https://doi.org/10.1086/202782) (<https://doi.org/10.1086%2F202782>).
 - Coe, Michael D. (1992). *Breaking the Maya Code* (https://archive.org/details/breakingmayacode00coem_0). London: Thames and Hudson. ISBN 0-500-05061-9.
 - Foster, Lynn V. (2002). *Handbook to Life in the Ancient Mayan World*. New York: [Facts on File](#).
 - Kettunen, Harri; Christophe Helmke (2005). *Introduction to Maya Hieroglyphs: 10th European Maya Conference Workshop Handbook* (<http://www.mesoweb.com/resources/handbook/>) (pdf). Leiden: Wayeb and Leiden University. Retrieved 2006-06-08.
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